

Audience generation

Microsoft Advertising Platform

 Microsoft Advertising



Availability information

Audience generation



Status

Closed beta



Markets

United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Australia



Languages

English



Entry points

Microsoft Advertising UI
Desktop

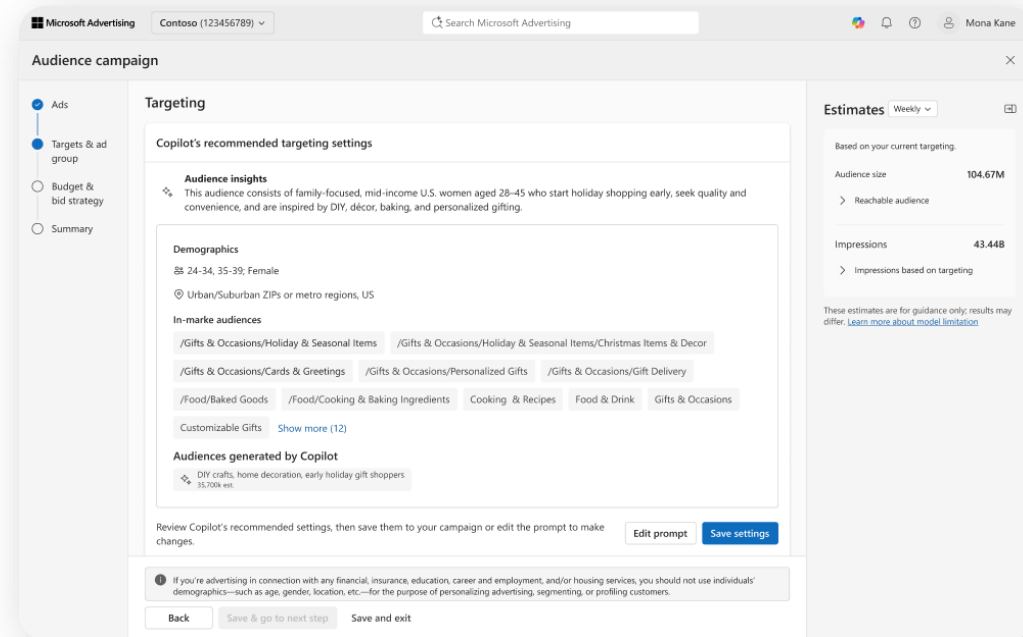


Ad type

Audience ads

Audience generation

Turn your audience ideas into actionable targeting, instantly



Create audiences using natural language

Describe who you want to reach in plain language. Audience generation translates that intent into ready-to-use audience targeting, without manual setup.

Reach the right customers with more precision

Go beyond static, predefined segments. Audience generation helps capture nuance and intent by creating tailored audiences alongside familiar targeting controls such as demographics or in-market audiences, helping you avoid overly broad targeting.

Stay in control with transparent recommendations

AI suggests audiences, but you decide what to use. Review recommended targeting, and confidently activate what works best for your campaign goals.

Set-up guide

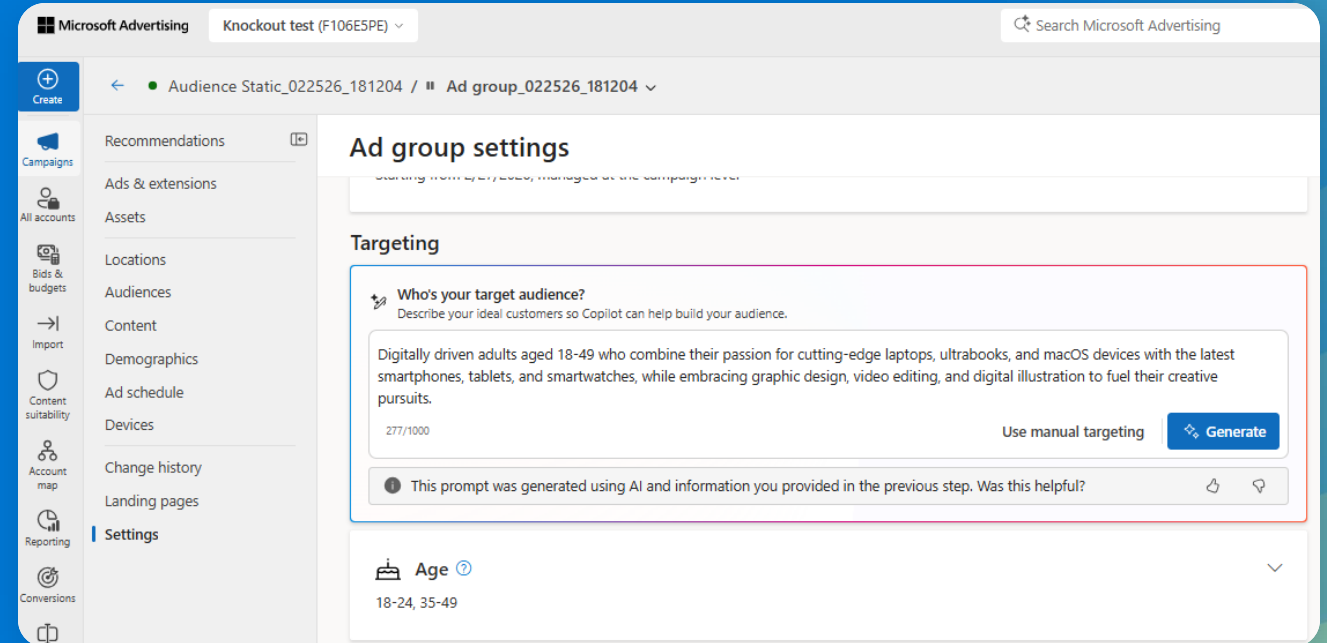
Audience generation

01

Setup guide

Audience generation can be accessed when creating a new campaign or when editing an existing campaign.

To access audience generation in an existing campaign, navigate to ad group settings



02

Setup guide

When creating a new campaign, audience generation is available in the second step, where you set your targeting and ad group settings.

From this view, you can describe your target audience using audience generation or choose manual targeting to add targeting parameters without using audience generation.

The screenshot shows the 'Ad group, audiences, & targets' setup screen in Microsoft Advertising. On the left is a sidebar with four steps: 'Ads' (selected with a blue dot), 'Targets & ad group' (selected with a blue dot), 'Budget & bid strategy', and 'Summary'. The main content area is titled 'Ad group, audiences, & targets' and contains two sections. The first section, 'Ad group name', has a text input field with the placeholder 'New ad group' and a character count '244 characters remaining'. The second section, 'Targeting', has a heading 'Who's your target audience?' with a subtext 'Describe your ideal customers so Copilot can help build your audience.' Below this is a large text input field with the placeholder 'Enter a description of your ideal customer, such as demographics, interests, or behaviors...'. At the bottom of this field is a character count '0/1000'. To the right of the input field are two buttons: 'Use manual targeting' and 'Generate' (which has a small icon of a person with a plus sign).

03

Setup guide

Describe your target audience in natural language in the text field provided. Once you are happy with your input, click generate

The screenshot shows a web interface for setting up an ad campaign. On the left is a vertical sidebar with four items: 'Ads' (checked), 'Targets & ad group' (selected with a blue dot), 'Budget & bid strategy', and 'Summary'. The main content area is titled 'Ad group, audiences, & targets'. It contains two sections: 'Ad group name' with a text input field containing 'Ad_group_032326_140317' and a '234 characters remaining' indicator; and 'Targeting' which includes a prompt 'Who's your target audience?' with a subtext 'Describe your ideal customers so Copilot can help build your audience.' Below this is a text input field containing 'Brooklyn-based consumers, aged 20-45, with disposable income, attending concerts, festivals, and pop-up events this spring and looking for nearby shopping and dining locations'. At the bottom of the targeting section are two options: 'Use manual targeting' and a blue 'Generate' button. A character count '175/1000' is visible at the bottom left of the targeting section.

Ads

Targets & ad group

Budget & bid strategy

Summary

Ad group, audiences, & targets

Ad group name ?

Ad_group_032326_140317

234 characters remaining

Targeting

Who's your target audience?
Describe your ideal customers so Copilot can help build your audience.

Brooklyn-based consumers, aged 20-45, with disposable income, attending concerts, festivals, and pop-up events this spring and looking for nearby shopping and dining locations

175/1000

Use manual targeting

Generate

04

Setup guide

Review the audience suggestions that Copilot recommends for your campaign, including the newly generated audience based on your prompt.

If needed, you can edit your prompt to generate new suggestions. Otherwise, select **save settings** to move to the next step.

Targeting

Audience generation

Demographics

18-24, 25-34, 35-49

Brooklyn, New York, United States, US

In-marketing audiences

Dining and Nightlife/Restaurants

Dining and Nightlife/Dining and Nightlife Reviews, Guides and Listings

Audiences generated by Copilot

Event-Loving Urban Explorers
4,138 est.

Review Copilot's recommended settings, then save them to your campaign or edit the prompt to make changes. You have 500 audiences generated by Copilot remaining today.

Edit prompt

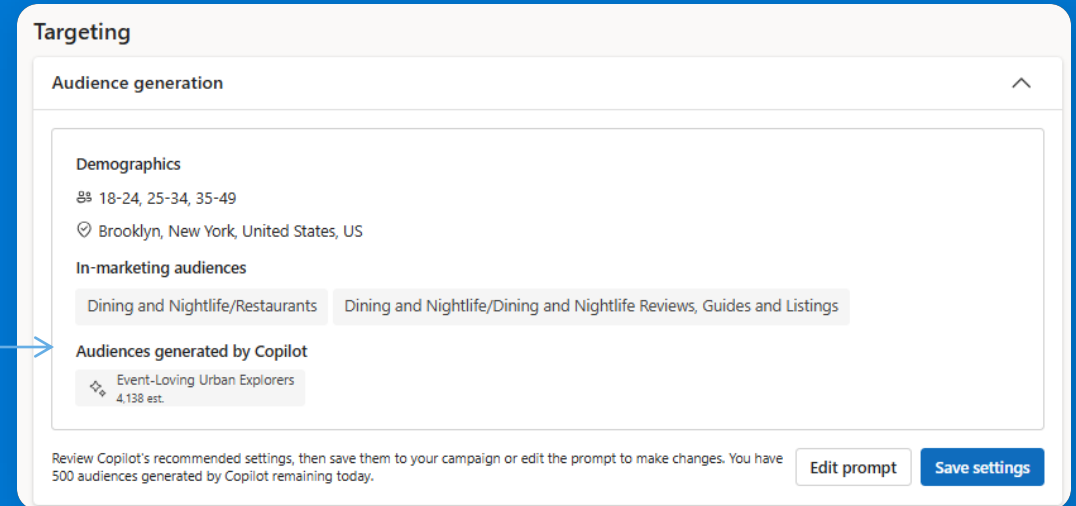
Save settings

What is an audience generated by Copilot?

An audience generated by Copilot is unique to you and the prompt you provide.

These audiences are built using Microsoft audience intelligence and billions of cross-device, first-party signals to help you reach the right users more effectively.

Please note that it can take up to 72 hours to see delivery against Copilot generated audiences.



Prompting best practices

Audience generation works best when prompts are clear and intentional. These best practices show how to guide Copilot toward stronger audience recommendations

BE CLEAR ABOUT WHO YOU WANT TO REACH

Describe your ideal customer as specifically as possible, including relevant traits such as interests and intent. Clear prompts help Copilot generate more accurate and relevant audiences

START SIMPLE AND REFINE

Begin with a straightforward prompt, review the suggested audience, and then adjust your prompt if needed. Small refinements often lead to better results than starting with overly complex instructions

FOCUS ON INTENT, NOT JUST DEMOGRAPHICS

Instead of listing broad attributes, describe what your audience is trying to do, buy, or solve. This helps Copilot identify users based on real behavior and signals, not static characteristics

AVOID OVERLY BROAD OR VAGUE LANGUAGE

Generic prompts like “everyone interested in travel” can lead to less focused audiences. Adding context, such as travel type, timeframe, or intent, helps Copilot narrow in on the right users

Frequently asked questions

Audience generation

Frequently asked questions

Audience generation

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|----|---|--|
| 01 | Where can I access the audience generation feature? | Audience generation is accessed during campaign creation or editing an existing campaign within Microsoft Advertising, only for Audience campaigns. |
| 02 | What does audience generation do? | Audience generation allows advertisers to describe their target audience in a natural-language prompt. The system then generates suggested audience segments and targeting approaches aligned to that definition. Advertisers can review the outputs and decide which to use in their campaigns. |
| 03 | Can I use audience generation on my Search or Performance Max campaigns? | Audience generation is currently only supported for Audience campaigns. |
| 04 | Will audience generation also recommend exclusions? | Audience generation will recommend which audiences to target, as well as generating a bespoke audience based on your input. It will not recommend which audiences to exclude. |

Frequently asked questions

Audience generation

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|----|--|--|
| 05 | Will audiences be set to bid only or target and bid? | The audience generated by copilot for your specific prompt will be applied using "target and bid". All other targeting suggested by audience generation can be set to "bid only" or "target and bid" |
| 06 | Are LinkedIn audiences suggested by audience generation? | LinkedIn is not included during the early pilot. We will add this in the future. |
| 07 | Can I report on performance for the audience generated by copilot? | Yes. You can report on performance using reports. Support to view performance in the campaigns grid will come later. |
| 08 | Can I edit or regenerate an audience after it's created? | Yes. You can update your prompt and regenerate audience suggestions at any time before saving your campaign settings. |

Frequently asked questions

Audience generation

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|----|--|---|
| 09 | What data is used to generate audiences? | Audience generation uses Microsoft audience intelligence and aggregated, privacy-safe first-party signals. No personally identifiable information is shared with advertisers. |
| 06 | Is my prompt or generated audience visible to other advertisers? | No. Generated audiences are unique to your account and based on your specific prompt. |
| 07 | How long does it take to see delivery for an audience generated by Copilot? | It can take up to 72 hours before you will see delivery against the audience list that Copilot generates for you based on your prompt. |
| 08 | Can I run a lift study when using Audience generation? | Audiences generated by Copilot when using Audience generation are not yet supported for lift studies. This functionality will be added in the future. |

Frequently asked questions

Audience generation

10

How many Copilot generated audiences can I apply to a campaign or ad group?

You can apply more than one Copilot-generated audience to a campaign or ad group. The one thing to watch: generating a *new* Copilot audience replaces the audiences currently selected (before you save). So to keep more than one, follow this sequence:

- Create/generate the new AI segment.
- Once you're satisfied with it, add any previously created segments.
- Click **Save**.

Once an AI segment has been created, it can be added in the same way as any other audience segment.

Thank you

Combine dimensions and learn about targeting

We support "AND" across dimensions and "OR" within dimensions

"AND"

"OR"

Targeting dimensions	Segments			Predictive Targeting
Gender	Male	Female		"OR"
Age	[18-24] [25-34]	[35-49] [50-64]	[65+]	
Audience	- Remarketing - In-market Audiences - Custom Combination - Customer Match	- Dynamic Remarketing - Similar Audiences - Impression-based remarketing - Job titles, company size - Custom segments* - Audiences generated by copilot*		
LinkedIn Profile Targeting	Company	Industry	Job Function	
Device	PC	Mobile	Tablet	"AND"
Location	- All available countries/regions - Selected cities and metropolitan areas - A specified radius around a postal code, coordinates, landmark or area			
Content	- Placements* - Topic*			

Across Dimensions

You can combine any of these dimensions by using **"AND."**

For example, you can target by gender **AND** by job title.

This makes your total pool smaller.

Within Dimensions

You can combine any of these dimensions by using **"OR."**

For example, you can target a user on PC **OR** mobile.

This makes your total pool bigger.

Examples of supported formats:

- ✓ [Age: (35-49)] **AND** [Inmarket: (Travel)]
- ✓ [Age: (18-24) **OR** (35-49)] **AND** [Inmarket: (Travel) **OR** (Finance)]
- ✓ [LinkedIn Company: (Microsoft) **OR** LinkedIn Job Function: (Marketing)]

Examples of unsupported formats:

- ✗ [Age: (18-24) **OR** (35-49)] **AND** [In-market: (Travel) **AND** (Remarketing list 1)]
- ✗ [Age: (18-24) **AND** In-market: (Travel)] **OR** [Age: (35-49) **AND** In-market: (Finance)]
- ✗ [LinkedIn Company: (Microsoft) **AND** LinkedIn Job Function: (Marketing)]

Remember, the more dimensions you combine, the smaller your reach.

*In pilot